

the latter more so now with a flood of sub-10k devices, while the former more resonant with affluent consumers who don't compromise on quality. While considering iOS, you're restricted to just two devices -- iPhone and iPad -- whereas Android is proliferant on a multitude of devices from a variety of manufacturers, and all sorts of form factors. iOS and Android are both extremely popular among developers as well, ensuring any supported device you buy will have a ton of apps -- not just now, but also in the future. iOS appears to be more polished overall compared to Android, with even third-party apps and menus -- it benefits a lot from Apple's tight control over the platform. Android, in many ways, is a more open and thereby a far more fragmented ecosystem in comparison, where every device manufacturer having the freedom to skin and tweak the OS as per their whims. So where Android will look (and even behave) different from



one smartphone and tablet to another, you won't face any such 'issues' with iOS. You should buy into Android if you're heavily integrated into Google's services and love the freedom it offers, while iOS should be your platform of choice if you're looking at experiencing arguably the best touchscreen OS out there.

Windows Phone and Windows 8 for smartphones and tablets, respectively, have joined the hunt for consumers relatively late compared to the big two. On a touch-enabled device, the platform appears relatively fresh and different than both iOS and Android. The integration of Facebook, Microsoft Office and Xbox LIVE at the OS' core gives the platform a slight edge over its competitors, but it still lags behind the other two in terms of wooing developers and boasting of a formidable app ecosystem. It's worth considering if you want to try something different than iOS and Android for a change.

Blackberry (formerly RIM) recently went in for a reform of sorts, having not only changed its company name but also developed a brand new OS